

the Top 50 companies are a mix of PSUs, family businesses, traditional sectors and tech companies. Or that it is simply harder to get into an IIM than an international programme. As India gets assimilated in the global way of doing business, and as the C-1 level leaders ascend, a lot of Indian MBAs will become CEOs, say the top academics.

Admittedly, the track record of Indian B-schools in seeding top CEOs is not worth crowing about. And while the IIMs, ISBs and a handful of other institutes can still claim to be centres of excellence with several notable alumni in their rosters, the same cannot be said for a majority of India's 3,000+ B-schools, which fall short of being aspirational for both students and recruiters. And even for the IIMs et al, their lacklustre global rankings paint a sobering reality. For instance, the QS World University Rankings–Full Time MBA: Global 2023 of Top 100 colleges has only four Indian B-schools—IIMA (44), IIM Bangalore (IIMB, 50), IIMC (68) and ISB Hyderabad and Mohali (78). And the Financial Times Global MBA Ranking 2023 which lists the world's Top 100 MBA programmes has just ISB (39), IIMA (51), IIMB (52), IIMC (76), IIM Indore (IIMI, 89) and IIM Lucknow (IIML, 90).

This raises the question—why do Indian B-schools struggle to meet global standards? This is especially pertinent at a time when economic power shifts to

Decoding Accreditations

AMBA The only accreditation of the three that focusses on MBA programmes specifically. It scrutinises faculty, curriculum and student experience. After five years, a programme is re-accredited

AACSB It's a business school accreditation, not that of a programme. The agency reviews the school's mission, faculty qualifications, curricula, and ensures students are learning material relevant to their fields. The accreditation process can take three-five years

EQUIS The European Foundation for Management Development's Quality Improvement System assesses business schools as a whole. It places more focus on diversity and internationalisation. Re-accreditation can take place up to five years after initial accreditation

Is it time to rethink CAT?

BY AAKANKSHA CHATURVEDI



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TILL 1983, IIM Ahmedabad, Bangalore and Calcutta conducted their own, separate entrance tests. But when IIM Lucknow opened for students in 1984, the B-schools decided to institute a single, common exam. Each year, one of the colleges would set the exam and, in 1984, the first CAT exam was conducted for candidates aspiring to enter the IIMs. Over time, other Indian B-schools also started accepting CAT results for admissions. The exam evolved, too, with change in pattern, medium, content and duration. Still, the exam has not received global recognition like a GMAT or a GRE.

Experts believe this is because CAT has some glaring issues. For starters, as Suresh K. Jakhar, Chairperson, PGP, and Associate Professor at Indian Institute of Management Lucknow, says, "CAT favours more quantitative and engineering competencies in the long term. That's why a lot of male engineers perform well in CAT and get the top percentile." Adds SPJIMR's Dean Varun Nagaraj: "For example, if you come from Ashoka University and you've done something amazing in sociology, you are at a disadvantage in the CAT exam compared to someone who has gone to an